

Word family: **reflect / reflects / reflected / reflecting / reflection / reflective**

Base word: reflect

Past tense: reflected

Past participle: reflected

ing form: reflecting

Related forms: reflection, reflective

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun-related form (相關名詞) / adjective-related form (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “At present, I still run into him from time to time, and every conversation leaves me with something to **reflect on**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **reflect on** means to **think carefully and deeply about something, especially after an experience or conversation**.

The speaker means that after talking to Mr. Wong, he is left with ideas worth thinking about more seriously.

繁體中文： **在事情發生之後，認真而深入地思考其內容、原因、意義或帶來的啟發**

中文翻譯：

> “...every conversation leaves me with something to **reflect on**.”

「.....每一次談話都會留給我一些值得**反思 / 仔細思考**的東西。」

Here:

reflect on something = 對某件事情作深入思考和反省

Because **reflect on** is essential to the exact passage, it should be treated explicitly even though the Manual normally avoids expanding phrasal constructions unless needed for the target sentence.

1. **reflect + light/image/sound (光 / 影像 / 聲音) — 反射**

This is the basic physical meaning.

Meaning: To send light, heat, sound, or an image back from a surface rather than absorb it.

Practice 1

> “The mirror **reflected** the light from the window.”

「鏡子**反射**了窗外照進來的光。」

Practice 2

> “The mountains were **reflected** in the lake.”

「山的影像**倒映**在湖面上。」

reflect = 表面把光、熱、聲音或影像返回，而不是完全吸收

Common:

- * reflect light
- * reflect heat
- * reflect sound
- * reflected image
- * reflected in water

These all belong to the same physical sense.

2. **reflect** = show/reveal a quality or situation (顯示 / 反映) — 反映；顯示

This is a major figurative meaning.

Meaning: To show, represent, or reveal the nature, quality, condition, attitude, or situation of something.

Practice 3

> “The results **reflect** the students' hard work.”

「結果**反映**了學生的努力。」

Practice 4

> “Her choice of words **reflects** her personality.”

「她的用詞**反映出**她的性格。」

****reflect something = 顯示或呈現某個人的特質、某件事的狀況或某種整體現象****

Common:

- * reflect reality
- * reflect changes
- * reflect attitudes
- * reflect values
- * reflect personality

These are one underlying representational sense.

3. ****reflect on/upon + experience/idea/problem (思考 / 反思) — 反思 ; 仔細思考****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To think carefully, deeply, and deliberately about something.

Practice 5 — Original

> “Every conversation leaves me with something to ****reflect on****.”

「每一次談話都會留給我一些值得****反思 / 仔細思考****的東西。」

Practice 6

> “She took some time to ****reflect on**** what had happened.”

「她花了一些時間****反思 / 仔細思考****發生過的事情。」

Practice 7

> “We should ****reflect on**** what we learned from the experience.”

「我們應該****反思****自己從這次經歷中學到了甚麼。」

****reflect on/upon something = 對某件事情作深入、審慎而有意識的思考****

This is genuinely different from physical reflection and from simply “showing” something.

4. ****reflect well/badly on + person/organization (評價 / 形象) — 令.....顯得好 / 差 ; 影響形象****

This is another common figurative use.

Practice 8

> “His behaviour **reflects badly on** the whole team.”

「他的行為會令整個團隊**形象受損 / 顯得不好**。」

Practice 9

> “The successful event **reflected well on** the organizers.”

「活動成功舉行，令主辦者**留下良好形象 / 得到正面評價**。」

reflect well/badly on someone = 某件事情令別人對某人或某機構形成較好或較差的評價

For core counting, I would treat this as a branch of Meaning 2:

> **something reveals or shapes how a person/organization is viewed**

rather than a wholly separate meaning.

5. **reflect** = consider before deciding/responding (考慮) — 深思；審慎考慮

A more formal use of **reflect** can mean considering something carefully before reaching a conclusion.

Practice 10

> “He paused to **reflect** before answering.”

「他停了一下，先**仔細思考**才回答。」

Practice 11

> “The committee needs time to **reflect** before making a final decision.”

「委員會需要時間**審慎考慮**，才作最後決定。」

reflect = 在作出決定、回應或判斷之前進行深入思考

This is closely related to **reflect on**, so for database counting I would merge it with Meaning 3.

Related form: **reflection**

Reflection has several important corresponding senses.

reflection = image seen in a reflective surface (倒影 / 映像)

Practice 12

> “She looked at her **reflection** in the mirror.”

「她看着鏡中的**倒影 / 映像**。」

Practice 13

> “The lights created beautiful **reflections** on the water.”

「燈光在水面形成漂亮的**倒影**。」

reflection = 光線被表面反射後形成的影像

reflection = careful thought (反思 / 思考)

Practice 14

> “After some **reflection**, he changed his mind.”

「經過一番**深思 / 反思**後，他改變了想法。」

Practice 15

> “The essay is a personal **reflection** on childhood.”

「這篇文章是對童年的個人**反思**。」

reflection = 對某個經歷、問題或想法所作的深入思考

reflection = sign/representation of something (反映)

Practice 16

> “The building is a **reflection** of the city’s changing identity.”

「這座建築是城市身份轉變的一種**反映 / 體現**。」

Practice 17

> “The figures are a clear **reflection** of current demand.”

「這些數字清楚**反映**了目前的需求。」

reflection = 能顯示或體現某種狀況、特質或現象的事物

Related form: **reflective**

Reflective also has two especially useful senses.

reflective = thoughtful (深思的 ; 善於反思的)

Practice 18

> “He became quiet and **reflective** after the conversation.”

「談話之後，他變得安靜而**若有所思**。」

Practice 19

> “She is a very **reflective** person.”

「她是一個很**善於反思 / 深思熟慮**的人。」

reflective = 經常深入思考自己的經歷、想法或行為的

reflective = sending light back (反光的)

Practice 20

> “Cyclists should wear **reflective** clothing at night.”

「騎單車的人晚上應穿着**反光衣物**。」

Practice 21

> “The sign has a **reflective** surface.”

「這個標誌有一個**反光表面**。」

reflective = 能把光線反射回去的

This is a useful family contrast:

reflective person = 善於反思的

reflective material = 反光的

Important distinction: **reflect** vs **think**

think

is very broad.

It can mean:

- * have an opinion
- * use your mind
- * consider something

reflect

usually suggests slower, deeper, more deliberate thought.

> “I thought about the meeting.”

= 我想過那次會議。

> “I reflected on the meeting.”

= 我更深入地反思那次會議的意義和影響。

So **reflect** is usually more thoughtful and deliberate than ordinary **think**.

Important distinction: **reflect** vs **consider**

consider

often means examine something before making a choice or judgment.

reflect

often emphasizes thoughtful contemplation, especially after an experience.

> “We considered three options.”

= 我們考慮了三個選項。

> “We reflected on what went wrong.”

= 我們反思了哪裡出了問題。

There is overlap, but the typical focus differs.

Important distinction: **reflect vs represent**

reflect

means something naturally shows or reveals a quality/state.

represent

can mean deliberately stand for, depict, or act on behalf of something.

> “The figures reflect current demand.”

= 數字自然顯示需求狀況。

> “The symbol represents peace.”

= 符號代表和平。

So they overlap in “showing,” but **represent** is broader and often more deliberate/conventional.

Important distinction: **reflect vs mirror**

As verbs, they can overlap figuratively.

> “The report reflects public concern.”

> “The report mirrors public concern.”

Both can mean:

「報告反映公眾的憂慮。」

But **mirror** often emphasizes a very close correspondence, while **reflect** is more general.

Important distinction: **reflection** vs **shadow**

reflection

= image formed when light bounces from a surface

shadow

= dark shape formed when an object blocks light

So:

> reflection in a mirror

> shadow on a wall

These are different optical phenomena.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **reflect**

* **reflected**

* **reflecting**

* **reflection**

* **reflective**

The most important semantic branches are:

* physical reflection

* figurative representation

* thoughtful reflection

And the most useful related-form contrast is:

* **reflective surface** = 反光的

* **reflective person/mood** = 深思的 / 善於反思的

The Golden Manual requires useful related forms and genuine part-of-sense contrasts to be included, while closely related contexts should still be merged where appropriate.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
reflect — light/image/sound	表面把光、熱、聲音或影像返回，而不是完全吸收；反射 / 倒映
reflect — show/reveal	顯示、呈現或體現某個人的特質、某件事的狀況或某種現象
reflect on/upon something	對某件事情進行深入、審慎而有意識的思考或反省
reflect well/badly on someone	某件事情令別人對某人或某機構形成較好或較差的印象；屬於「顯示 / 反映」義
reflection — image	光線被反射後形成的倒影或映像
reflection — thought	對經歷、問題或想法所作的深入思考或反省
reflection — representation	能顯示或體現某種狀況、特質或現象的事物
reflective — thoughtful	經常深入思考自己的經歷、想法或行為的
reflective — light-returning	能把光線反射回去的；反光的

For your original sentence

> “...every conversation leaves me with something to **reflect on**.”

The exact meaning is:

****reflect on** = 對某件事作深入、審慎的思考，尤其思考其意義、原因或帶來的啟發

So:

> ****something to reflect on****

= ****一些值得仔細思考 / 反思的事情****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****reflect****:

1. ****physically reflect light, sound, heat, or an image****
2. ****show, reveal, or represent a quality, condition, attitude, or situation****
3. ****think deeply and carefully about something****

I would merge **reflect well/badly on** into #2 and merge bare **reflect = think carefully** with **reflect on/upon** under #3 rather than create artificial extra senses.